

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **OPEC members** struggling to preserve market share amid a sinking oil price now have to contend with Trump's move to dominate Venezuela's oil supply. **A1**

◆ **After the U.S. capture** of Nicolás Maduro in a raid on Caracas, investors are sprinting to exploit Trump's ambitions to dominate the Western Hemisphere. **B1**

◆ **China's national champion** in memory-chip manufacturing is preparing a \$4 billion share offering after making significant technical advances, upending an industry dominated by South Korean and U.S. companies. **B1**

◆ **U.S. investors** are putting the best face on recent indicators, piling into trades that suggest they are confident that the economy will keep powering forward. **B1**

◆ **The latest jobs data** point to a labor market that has settled into a low-hire, low-fire stasis that shuts out the unemployed who are seeking work. **A3**

◆ **Applicants bucking** the status quo are being taken on at high wages to train artificial intelligence to replace them in the roles they once held. **A5**

◆ **Allegiant Travel** reached a roughly \$1 billion deal to buy Sun Country Airlines as budget-focused U.S. airlines struggle with stiff competition from larger rivals. **B2**

◆ **Trump's purchasing-power** recipe for addressing high housing costs will need to be augmented by a meaningful increase in home supply, analysts and economists say. **A2**

◆ **Walmart plans to launch** many more drones this year, making deliveries by sky available to tens of millions of U.S. shoppers. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **Federal prosecutors** are investigating Powell over the Fed's building renovation project. He accused Trump of using the probe as a pressure tactic to get the central bank to lower interest rates. **A1**

◆ **Trump is scheduled** to be briefed on options to respond to the protests in Iran, a sign the president is considering reprimanding the regime for its crackdown. **A1**

◆ **Iranian authorities'** repression of the discontent in the streets has left at least 500 people dead at a time when Tehran's image of invincibility has been shattered. **A8**

◆ **The Defense Department** chose a former Wall Street trader and Marine to lead its highest-profile unit tasked with bringing startup technology into the U.S. military. **A3**

◆ **OpenAI** and a nonprofit group that has opposed it said they would work together on a ballot proposal to regulate how chatbots interact with children. **A3**

◆ **South Africa** is welcoming Iranian, Russian and Chinese warships to its waters for naval exercises in what Trump is likely to see as a provocation to the U.S. **A7**

◆ **The U.S. conducted** strikes against Islamic State at locations across Syria in response to the killing of U.S. soldiers last month. **A8**

◆ **Israel and Hamas** are preparing for renewed fighting as the Palestinian militant group refuses to disarm, a requirement that is holding up progress on Trump's Gaza plan. **A7**

◆ **Died: Bob Weir**, 78, Grateful Dead co-founder. **A3**



In Paris, protesters in a demonstration against the Iranian regime Sunday waved Iran's flags from before its Islamic revolution.

U.S. Steps Up Iran Planning, Studies Possible Military Action

Trump sets meeting on unrest response as heavy death toll is reported at protests

WASHINGTON—President Trump is scheduled to be briefed Tuesday on options to respond to the protests in Iran, according to U.S. officials, a sign the president is considering reprimanding the regime for its crackdown on demonstrators as he has repeatedly threatened.

By Alexander Ward, Lara Seligman and Benoit Faucon

The president's planned meeting with senior administration officials will be a discussion about the next steps, which could include boosting antigovernment sources online, deploying secretive cyber weapons against Iranian military and civilian sites, placing more sanctions on the regime and military strikes, the officials said.

Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Joint Chiefs Chair Gen. Dan Caine are expected to attend the Tuesday meeting, the officials said.

Trump said Sunday on Air Force One that he had been reviewing military options to strike Iran after the regime

was "starting to" cross his red line of not killing protesters.

"We're looking at some very strong options," he said. If Iran retaliates to an American attack by targeting U.S. troops in the region, "we will hit them at levels that they've never been hit before." He also said "the leaders of Iran called," and "they want to negotiate."

Trump isn't expected to make a final decision at the meeting as the deliberations are at an early stage. On Sunday, Iran's parliamentary speaker threatened to attack American military bases in the Middle East if the U.S. acted first. The U.S. maintains air and naval bases in the United Arab Emirates, Bah-

rain and Qatar. Iran struck Al Udeid Air Base in Qatar last June after the U.S. bombed Iranian nuclear facilities.

Mohammad-Bagher Ghalibaf, speaker of the Iranian Parliament, said that in addition to hitting U.S. bases, Iran would strike Middle Eastern shipping lanes and Israel.

Around 490 protesters and 48 members of security services have been killed in the Iranian unrest, according to Human Rights Activists in Iran. State television channel IRIB on Sunday broadcast footage of a large number of bodies in

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◆ **Tehran faces its toughest challenge yet.....** A8

Trump's Venezuela Oil Grab Worries OPEC

By Georgi Kantchev and Summer Said

OPEC members struggling to preserve their market share amid a sinking price for oil now have an unexpected new variable to contend with: President Trump's move to dominate Venezuela's oil supply and push the market in a direction that would benefit American consumers.

Trump, who has long championed increased oil production and a target price of \$50 a barrel, is planning a sweeping initiative to rehabilitate Venezuela's oil fields and market its output, people familiar with the matter said.

That would reshape the global oil map—putting the U.S. in charge of the output of one of the founding members of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and, along with America's own prodigious production, give it a potentially disruptive role in a market already struggling with oversupply.

While analysts expect that reviving Venezuela's dilapidated oil industry will take huge investments and a lot of time, they say even a small

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
As people dial back drinking and bosses trim fun budgets, happy hour takes a hit. **A12**



SPORTS
The college football title game that absolutely no one saw coming. **A18**

Inside North Korea's Obsession With Dominating Girls' Soccer

The sport has become something of an athletic arbitrage for the country

By Dasl Yoon and Timothy W. Martin

SEOUL—After the last whistle blew at the youth women's World Cup final in November, the Netherlands coach sounded dejected. His side had just lost 3-0.

"I don't think we could have beaten them," the coach conceded.

The Netherlands squad had just run into North Korea.

Youth women's soccer, alongside weightlifting and table tennis, is something of an athletic arbitrage for cash-strapped North Korea. The Kim regime figures other nations won't subject preteen

girls to arduous training. That's left opportunities for outside achievement for a government perennially hunting for propaganda victories and international prestige.

Rival players and coaches say the young North Korean women possess unmatched stamina, mental toughness and physical aggression. "They don't let you breathe," said Irune Dorado, a Spanish midfielder, after losing to the North Koreans in 2024.

Yoon Duk-yeo, a former South Korean women's national team manager, recalled the tenacity he saw in the North Korean athletes' eyes. They would

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The Con Artist and The Masterpiece

Alleged fraud involves a London gallery and Bruce Springsteen's manager

By Jenny Strasburg and Kelly Crow

A venerable London art dealer, Patrick Matthiesen was in his second-floor gallery office last year surrounded by stacks of books on the old masters when he opened an email that confirmed his worst fears.

"This will be short," the March 4 email began. "I lied..."

The sender was an American whom Matthiesen knew as A.J. Doyle. Over a correspondence spanning more than two years, Doyle had regaled the dealer with tantalizing tales of life as a former Navy fighter pilot with connections throughout the art world and control over a \$2.5 billion family fortune.

Matthiesen, who is 82 years old, grew to trust his

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Supplements Backers Get Boost From RFK

By Sara Ashley O'Brien

When Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. released his MAHA Report in May, a who's who of the wellness world convened at the White House. There was physician Mark Hyman, who co-founded the direct-to-consumer testing company Function Health, recently valued at \$2.5 billion. Also in attendance: Alex Clark, host of the Turning Point USA podcast "Culture Apothecary." Longevity influencer Gary Brecka, who'd recently had Kennedy over to get intravenous drips and use Brecka's hyperbaric chamber, was present, along with the "medfluencers" Dr. Will Cole and Dr. Paul Saladino.

All of them support Ken-

nedy's ascent to the top U.S. health job. And all of them stand to gain from the spotlight he has placed on alternative health. That's because each of them has ties to the business of supplements, a \$70 billion, lightly regulated U.S. market that could benefit from his support. On Brecka's podcast, recorded after their wellness treatments, Kennedy vowed to end "the war on vitamins."

No one in the U.S. holds more sway over consumer health choices than Kennedy. As health secretary, he has promoted certain vitamins as treatments for infectious diseases such as measles. Supplement

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◆ **RFK Jr.'s rise mobilizes Democratic doctors.....** A4

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